



Windows 8 Homescreen

Usability

To someone coming from an old Gateway desktop into a brand new Ice Cream Sandwich Android tablet, it's a whole new world. Google and its hardware vendors assumed, it seems, that consumers buying Android tablets already had some experience with Android, or with Apple's iOS in the worst case. That leaves a large demographic of users coming from feature phones with little experience with the internet baffled in the face of Android's cold GUI.

Simply put, Windows has a huge advantage that it can capitalize on to make Windows tablets seem like home to users.

Applications

Microsoft's got everyone beat here. Documents are "Word docs" by default. Microsoft Outlook dominates email, from home to corporate clients. Whether anyone wants to admit it or not, Internet Explorer is still the king of browsers. When you look around, Microsoft isn't winning the game of applications, it's running it. All Sinofsky and co need to do is keep that familiar app set going on the tablet. If you reduce the learning curve on the applications you use, people will be comfortable with your product. Introducing a touch interface is just going to make the experience seem new and wondrous, not a chore.

As far as a base of applications, there's not going to be the shortage that Windows Mobile has. While Windows 8 is technically a new operating